

Word family: **squeeze / squeezes / squeezed / squeezing / squeezer / squeezable**

Base word: squeeze

Forms: squeezes, squeezed, squeezing

Related forms: squeezer, squeezable

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Elderly customers who simply want a place to rest are **squeezed out**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **squeezed out** means **forced out, excluded, or deprived of access because other people are occupying the limited space or resources available**.

The elderly customers are not literally being physically pressed. Rather, because tables and seats are taken for long periods, they effectively lose their opportunity to use the restaurant.

繁體中文： **被擠走；被排擠出去；因空間 / 資源不足而被迫失去位置或機會**

中文翻譯：

> “...elderly customers ... are **squeezed out**.”

「.....年長顧客.....因此被**擠走 / 排擠出去**。」

Here:

be squeezed out = 因其他人佔用了有限的空間、資源或機會，而被迫無法參與、使用或留下**

Because this construction appears in the exact passage, it should be retained even though **squeeze out** behaves like a phrasal/constructional extension.

1. **squeeze** = press firmly from two or more sides (擠壓) — 擠；壓；捏**

This is the central physical meaning.

Practice 1

> “She **squeezed** the sponge.”

「她用力**擠壓**海綿。」

Practice 2

> “Don’t **squeeze** the box too hard.”

「不要太用力**壓**那個盒子。」

Practice 3

> “He **squeezed** the tube with both hands.”

「他用雙手**擠壓**那支軟管。」

****squeeze = 從兩邊或四周施加壓力，使物件被壓縮、變形或變得更緊****

Common:

- * squeeze a sponge
- * squeeze a tube
- * squeeze someone’s arm
- * squeeze something tightly

2. ****squeeze = extract liquid by pressing (榨出) — 榨；擠出液體****

A major physical extension.

Practice 4

> “She **squeezed** the juice from a lemon.”

「她把檸檬汁**榨出來**。」

Practice 5

> “He **squeezed** the water out of the cloth.”

「他把布裡的水**擰 / 擠了出來**。」

****squeeze = 透過施壓把物件內的液體逼出來****

Common:

- * squeeze a lemon
- * squeeze an orange
- * squeeze juice out

* squeeze water from a cloth

For strict counting, this develops directly from Meaning 1 but is common enough to surface separately.

3. **squeeze = fit or force someone/something into a small space (塞進 / 擠進) — 擠進 ; 硬塞進**

Squeeze can mean making something fit where there is very little room.

Practice 6

> “We managed to **squeeze** five people into the car.”

「我們勉強把五個人**擠進**車裡。」

Practice 7

> “She **squeezed** the suitcase into the cupboard.”

「她把行李箱勉強**塞進**櫃裡。」

squeeze something/someone into something = 在空間不足的情況下勉強塞進去

This is a major everyday use.

4. **squeeze through/past = move through a narrow space (通過狹位) — 擠過 ; 側身穿過**

Practice 8

> “He **squeezed through** the narrow gap.”

「他從狹窄的縫隙中**擠了過去**。」

Practice 9

> “I had to **squeeze past** several people.”

「我不得不從幾個人旁邊**擠過去**。」

The core image remains:

> there is barely enough physical space.

5. **squeeze in = make room for someone/something despite limited space or time (騰位 / 騰時間) — 擠出位置 ; 勉強安排**

The same idea extends from physical space to schedules.

Practice 10

> “Can we **squeeze in** one more chair?”

「我們可以再**擠出位置放**一張椅子嗎？」

Practice 11

> “The doctor managed to **squeeze me in** before lunch.”

「醫生設法在午飯前**騰出時間替我看診**。」

This is constructional rather than a separate core meaning, but it is very common.

6. **squeeze out = force someone/something out because space/resources are limited (排擠) — 擠走 ; 排擠出去**

This is the **exact passage branch**.

Practice 12 — Original

> “Older customers may be **squeezed out** when tables are occupied for hours.”

「當桌子一連數小時被佔用時，年長顧客可能會被**擠走 / 排擠出去**。」

Practice 13

> “Small shops are being **squeezed out** by larger chains.”

「小型店舖正被大型連鎖企業**擠出市場 / 排擠出去**。」

Practice 14

> “Rising rents have **squeezed** many residents **out of** the area.”

「不斷上升的租金令許多居民被**迫離開**該區。」

squeeze someone out = 因競爭、成本、空間或資源限制，使某人逐漸沒有位置 / 機會而被迫退出

This is a major figurative development of physical crowding.

7. **squeeze = press someone affectionately or reassuringly (身體接觸) — 捏一下；緊握；輕抱**

A person may **squeeze** someone's hand, arm, shoulder, etc. to express affection, encouragement, or reassurance.

Practice 15

> “She **squeezed** my hand reassuringly.”

「她安慰地**握緊了一下**我的手。」

Practice 16

> “He gave his daughter a quick **squeeze**.”

「他輕輕**抱了女兒一下**。」

Here:

a squeeze = 一下緊握 / 輕抱

This is not necessarily painful or forceful.

8. **a squeeze = act of pressing tightly (名詞) — 一擠；一捏；一握**

Practice 17

> “Give the bottle a gentle **squeeze**.”

「輕輕**擠一下**瓶子。」

Practice 18

> “She gave my hand a **squeeze**.”

「她**握了我的手一下**。」

This is the noun counterpart of the physical verb.

9. **a squeeze of lemon/lime = small amount obtained by squeezing (少量汁液) — 擠出的一點汁**

Practice 19

> “Add a **squeeze** of lemon.”

「加一點**擠出的檸檬汁**。」

A common cooking expression:

> a squeeze of lemon/lime

= **擠一下所得的一點檸檬 / 青檸汁**

This stays under the extraction branch.

10. **a tight squeeze = very little physical room (狹窄) — 很擠；勉強塞得下**

Practice 20

> “Three people in the back seat would be a **tight squeeze**.”

「後座坐三個人會**非常擠迫**。」

Practice 21

> “It was a **tight squeeze**, but the sofa fitted through the doorway.”

「雖然**空間非常勉強**，但梳化最後還是穿過了門口。」

a tight squeeze = 空間剛剛夠，幾乎塞不下

11. **a tight squeeze = difficult situation with very little margin (比喻) — 險境；非常勉強的情況**

The physical expression can also become figurative.

Practice 22

> “We finished before the deadline, but it was a **“tight squeeze”**.”

「我們在限期前完成了，但時間真的**“非常緊迫 / 十分勉強”**。」

For core counting, this remains an extension of the limited-space concept.

12. **“squeeze = put someone/something under financial pressure (經濟) — 壓縮 ; 使承受財務壓力”**

A major figurative branch.

Practice 23

> “Higher costs are **“squeezing”** small businesses.”

「成本上升正在令小型企業承受很大的**“財務壓力”**。」

Practice 24

> “Households are being **“squeezed”** by rising prices.”

「物價上升令家庭的財政受到**“擠壓 / 壓力”**。」

“squeeze someone financially = 令其可用金錢、利潤或資源愈來愈少”

This metaphor imagines pressure being applied from both sides.

13. **“a financial/economic squeeze = period of severe financial pressure (經濟) — 財政緊縮 ; 經濟壓力”**

Practice 25

> “Families are feeling the financial **“squeeze”**.”

「家庭正在感受到沉重的**“財政壓力”**。」

Practice 26

> “The company is facing a profit **squeeze**.”

「公司正面對**利潤受壓 / 利潤空間被壓縮**的情況。」

Common:

* financial squeeze

* credit squeeze

* profit squeeze

* budget squeeze

* wage squeeze

14. **credit squeeze** = restricted availability of borrowing (金融) — **信貸緊縮**

A **credit squeeze** is a situation in which borrowing becomes harder or more expensive to obtain.

繁體中文： **信貸緊縮；貸款供應收緊**

This is an established economic compound.

It belongs to the broader financial-pressure branch.

15. **squeeze** = reduce the amount/margin available (壓縮) — **壓縮；縮減**

Profits, margins, budgets, time, etc. can be **squeezed**.

Practice 27

> “Competition has **squeezed** profit margins.”

「競爭已經**壓縮**了利潤空間。」

Practice 28

> “The project was **squeezed** by a limited budget.”

「這個項目受到有限預算的**限制 / 擠壓**。」

This belongs closely with Meaning 12.

16. **squeeze = pressure or coerce someone into giving money, information, etc. (施壓) — 逼迫 ; 榨取**

Informal **squeeze** can mean applying strong pressure to someone.

Practice 29

> “They tried to **squeeze** more money out of him.”

「他們試圖從他身上**榨取**更多金錢。」

Practice 30

> “The investigators **squeezed** him for information.”

「調查人員向他**施壓以取得情報**。」

****squeeze someone = 向某人施加壓力，希望取得金錢、資料、合作或某種讓步****

This is a genuine distinct figurative branch.

17. **put the squeeze on someone = pressure/coerce someone (固定表達) — 向某人施壓 ; 逼迫**

Practice 31

> “They put the **squeeze on** the supplier to lower its prices.”

「他們向供應商**施壓**，要求降低價格。」

****put the squeeze on someone = 以壓力迫使某人採取某項行動****

Often informal.

18. **squeeze someone dry = take nearly all their money/resources (固定表達) — 榨乾 ; 榨取殆盡**

Practice 32

> “High fees are **squeezing customers dry**.”

「高昂收費幾乎把顧客的錢**榨乾**了。」

This is a vivid metaphorical extension of extracting liquid.

19. **short squeeze = rapid price rise caused partly by short sellers buying back (金融) — 軋空 ; 空頭擠壓**

A major modern financial term.

A **short squeeze** occurs when the price of an asset rises and traders who had sold it short rush to buy it back to limit their losses, which can create additional buying pressure and push the price higher.

Practice 33

> “The stock rose sharply during a **short squeeze**.”

「該股票在**軋空 / 空頭擠壓**期間急升。」

The important conceptual idea is:

> short sellers are put under increasing pressure and forced to cover their positions.

This is specialist but widely encountered in financial news.

20. **squeeze play / squeeze bunt = baseball strategy (棒球) — 強迫取分戰術 ; 觸擊搶分**

In baseball, a **squeeze play** is a tactical play involving a bunt intended to allow a runner from third base to score.

Practice 34

> “The team attempted a **squeeze play**.”

「球隊嘗試了一次**強迫取分戰術**。」

This is a genuine specialist sports compound.

21. **squeeze play = pressure situation/strategy (比喻) — 夾擊策略 ; 施壓手段**

The baseball term can also be used figuratively for a situation in which someone is pressured from competing sides.

This is lower frequency outside specialist/business writing and does not need separate core status.

22. **main squeeze = romantic partner (美式非正式 / 略老派) — 戀人 ; 主要伴侶**

Practice 35

> “He brought his main **squeeze** to the party.”

「他帶了自己的**戀人 / 伴侶**去派對。」

This is informal and can sound humorous or dated.

Database status: genuine idiom, low priority.

Related form: **squeezable**

Squeezable means able to be squeezed easily.

Practice 36

> “The sauce comes in a **squeezable** bottle.”

「這種醬汁裝在一個**可擠壓的**瓶子裡。」

Useful but not especially high frequency.

Related form: **squeezer**

A **squeezer** is a tool/device used for squeezing.

Examples:

* lemon squeezer

* citrus squeezer

* hand squeezer

Practice 37

> “Use a lemon **squeezer** to extract the juice.”

「用檸檬**榨汁器**把汁榨出來。」

This is a transparent family noun.

Related form: **squeezy**

Especially in British English, **squeezy** may describe a soft container that can be squeezed.

> **squeezy bottle**

= **軟身擠壓瓶**

It is informal and lower priority.

Important distinction: **squeeze vs press**

press

is the broad verb for applying pressure.

squeeze

usually suggests pressure:

- * from opposite sides;
- * around something;
- * enough to compress it.

> press a button

> squeeze a sponge

You normally **press** a button, not squeeze it.

Important distinction: **squeeze vs crush**

squeeze

does not necessarily damage the object.

crush

implies much stronger pressure that damages, flattens, or destroys its structure.

> squeeze a lemon

> crush a can

Important distinction: **squeeze vs compress**

compress

is more technical/formal and means reduce volume by pressure.

squeeze

is everyday and often involves using hands or pressure from surrounding objects.

> compress a gas

> squeeze a sponge

Important distinction: **squeeze vs pinch**

pinch

usually means press a small amount of something between:

* finger and thumb;

* two narrow points.

squeeze

usually applies broader pressure.

> pinch your nose

> squeeze someone's hand

Important distinction: **squeeze vs hug**

hug

means put your arms around someone as an affectionate action.

squeeze

describes the pressure itself.

> “She hugged him and gave him a squeeze.”

A squeeze can be part of a hug.

Important distinction: **squeeze out vs exclude**

exclude

means deliberately or structurally keep someone out.

squeeze out

creates the image that limited:

- * space
- * money
- * resources
- * competition

gradually leaves no room for the person.

Compare:

> “They were excluded.”

neutral/general.

> “They were squeezed out.”

emphasizes pressure and lack of room/opportunity.

This nuance is exactly important in your passage.

Important distinction: **squeeze out vs push out**

push out

emphasizes causing someone to leave.

squeeze out

often suggests pressure builds because space/resources are becoming tighter.

> rising rents squeezed small businesses out

sounds especially natural.

Important distinction: **squeeze vs strain — finances**

financial strain

= financial difficulty or stress.

financial squeeze

= available money/profit/credit is being compressed or restricted.

They overlap, but **squeeze** emphasizes tightening resources.

Important distinction: **squeeze vs shortage**

shortage

means there is not enough of something.

squeeze

describes the pressure created by limited availability or rising costs.

A credit shortage can cause a credit squeeze.

Grammar note: **squeeze + object**

> squeeze the bottle

- > squeeze my hand
- > squeeze profits

The verb can be transitive.

Grammar note: ****squeeze into****

- > squeeze into a seat
- > squeeze five people into a car

= 勉強擠進 / 塞進。

Grammar note: ****squeeze through / past****

- > squeeze through a gap
- > squeeze past someone

= 在有限空間中擠過。

Grammar note: ****squeeze out****

Because it appears in your passage, this construction is essential:

Literal

- > squeeze water out of a cloth

= 把水擠出。

Figurative

- > squeeze competitors out of the market

= 把競爭者排擠出市場。

The metaphor changes from:

- > ****forcing material out by pressure****

to:

> ****forcing a person/group out by competitive/spatial pressure****

Countability note

As a noun:

Physical action

Countable:

> a squeeze

> two squeezes

Tight-space situation

Countable:

> a tight squeeze

Financial pressure

Usually singular/uncountable-like in expressions:

> the financial squeeze

> a credit squeeze

Finance

Countable:

> a short squeeze

> several short squeezes

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

* ****squeeze****

* ****squeezes****

* ****squeezed****

* ****squeezing****

* **squeezer**
* **squeezable**

Lower-priority:

* **squeezy**

Useful constructions and compounds include:

- * squeeze something
- * squeeze juice from
- * squeeze into
- * squeeze through
- * squeeze past
- * squeeze in
- * squeeze out
- * squeeze someone's hand
- * tight squeeze
- * financial squeeze
- * credit squeeze
- * profit squeeze
- * put the squeeze on
- * squeeze someone dry
- * short squeeze
- * squeeze play
- * main squeeze

The semantic network is unusually coherent:

> **physical pressure reduces available space**

From that image develop:

- * compression
- * extracting liquid
- * fitting into narrow spaces
- * forcing people out
- * reducing profits/resources
- * financial hardship
- * coercion

while **short squeeze** and **squeeze play** have become established specialist compounds.

Master comparison

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squeeze — physical pressure	從兩邊 / 周圍施壓，使物件被壓縮、變形或收緊
squeeze — extract liquid	透過施壓把物件中的液體榨 / 擠出
squeeze into	在空間不足下勉強把人 / 物塞進去
squeeze through/past	從狹窄空間或人群中擠過
squeeze in	在有限空間 / 時間中勉強騰出位置或安排
squeeze out — figurative	因空間、成本、競爭或資源有限而把某人 / 群體排擠出去
squeeze someone's hand / a squeeze	緊握、輕捏或輕抱，以表示感情 / 安慰
tight squeeze	空間、時間等只剛剛足夠；非常擠迫 / 勉強
squeeze — financial pressure	令個人 / 企業可用金錢、利潤或資源減少並承受壓力
financial/credit/profit squeeze	財務、信貸或利潤空間受到收緊 / 壓縮
squeeze — coerce	向某人施壓以取得金錢、資訊或讓步
put the squeeze on	向某人施加強大壓力 / 逼迫
squeeze someone dry	把某人的金錢 / 資源榨取殆盡
short squeeze	空頭被迫回補、進一步推高價格的金融市場現象
squeeze play	棒球強迫取分戰術；亦可有比喻施壓義
main squeeze	戀人 / 伴侶；美式非正式、略老派
squeezable	可以被擠壓的
squeezer	用來榨 / 擠東西的工具

For your original sentence

> “Elderly customers who simply want a place to rest are **squeezed out**.”

The exact meaning is:

****squeezed out = 餐廳有限的座位和空間長時間被其他人佔用，以致年長顧客沒有位置可用，實際上被排擠出去****

So:

> ****are squeezed out****

= ****被擠走 / 被排擠出去 / 失去使用空間的機會****

It is stronger and more vivid than simply:

> ****cannot find a seat****

because ****squeezed out**** suggests that ****limited space is under such pressure that one group effectively loses its place to another****.

For your database, I would count ****6 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****squeeze****:

1. **press/compress physically**
2. **extract liquid through pressure**
3. **fit/move through very limited space**
4. **press someone affectionately or reassuringly**
5. **figuratively force out / reduce available room, money, profit, or resources**
6. **pressure/coerce someone**

I would keep **financial squeeze** under #5, retain **squeeze out** prominently because it is the exact passage construction, and surface **short squeeze** as an important finance extension plus **squeeze play** and **main squeeze** as lower-priority established compounds/idioms.